

It's early enough in the life of blockchain technology that no books yet have focused solely on public blockchains and their native cryptoassets from the investing perspective. We are changing that because investors need to be aware of the opportunity and armed both to take advantage and protect themselves in the fray.

Inevitably, innovations of such magnitude, fueled by the mania of making money, can lead to overly optimistic investors. Investors who early on saw potential in Internet stocks encountered the devastating dot-com bubble. Stock in Books-A-Million saw its price soar by over 1,000 percent in one week simply by announcing it had an updated website. Subsequently, the price crashed and the company has since delisted and gone private. Other Internet-based high flyers that ended up crashing include Pets.com, Worldcom, and WebVan.¹¹ Today, none of those stocks exist.

Whether specific cryptoassets will survive or go the way of Books-A-Million remains to be seen. What's clear, however, is that some will be big winners. Altogether, between the assets native to blockchains and the companies that stand to capitalize on this creative destruction, there needs to be a game plan that investors use to analyze and ultimately profit from this new investment theme of cryptoassets. The goal of this book is not to predict the future—it's changing too fast for all but the lucky to be right—but rather to prepare investors for a variety of futures.

Bitcoin, the most widely known cryptoasset, has been riding a roller coaster. If one had invested \$100 in bitcoin in